



Blade Series — Session 2

General Awareness | SSC CGL Revision | 24 Questions



Geography · Economy · Polity · History · Science · Biology



① Geography — Brahmaputra River System

Q1. Lohit River is a tributary of which river?

- ☐ A Ganga
- ☐ B Yamuna
- ☒ C Brahmaputra ✓
- ☐ D Indus

✓ Answer: C — Lohit joins from Right Bank to form Brahmaputra in Assam

→ Brahmaputra — Names at Different Places

Tibet: **Yarlung Tsangpo** → Arunachal: **Siang** → **Dihang** → After joining Dibang + Lohit: **Brahmaputra** → Bangladesh: **Jamuna** → meets Padma (Ganga) → becomes **Meghna**

ORIGIN & SPECIAL FEATURE

Origin: **Chemayungdung / Angsi Glacier** (Tibet)

U-turn at **Namcha Barwa** (Syntaxial bending)

World's largest riverine island: **Majuli Island** (turns south at Duburi, Assam)

TRIBUTARIES

Right Bank: Lohit, Dhansari, Dibang

Left Bank: Subansari, Kameng, Manas, Teesta, Jaldhaka, Raidak

EXAM TRAP!

Barak River: Originates in **Manipur Hills** — **NOT** a tributary of Brahmaputra — joins Meghna in Bangladesh directly!



② Economy — LPG Reforms 1991

Q2. After 1991, industrial licensing was removed for most industries EXCEPT ___

- ☐ A Steel
- ☐ B Textiles
- ☒ C Hazardous chemicals, Alcohol, Cigarettes, Explosives ✓
- ☐ D Agriculture

✓ Answer: C — These industries still require license post-1991

→ **LPG = Liberalisation + Privatisation + Globalisation**

BACKGROUND

1990 → **Balance of Payments Crisis**

PM: **PV Narasimha Rao**

Finance Minister: **Manmohan Singh**

FDI vs FPI

FDI = Long-term, stable, structural

FPI = "Hot Money" (exits quickly)

IPR 1956 Schedule	Industries	Sector
Schedule A	17 industries	Public ONLY
Schedule B	12 industries	Public + Private
Schedule C	Remainder	Private sector

KEY FACTS

- Still need license post-1991: **Alcohol, Cigarettes, Explosives, Hazardous goods**
- Govt monopoly retained: **Defence, Railways, Atomic Energy**
- First IPR → **1948** (4 groups) | "Economic Constitution of India" → IPR **1956**



③ Geography — India's Physical Facts

Q3. India's land area is approximately what % of world's total area?

- A 1.2%
- B 2.4% ✓**
- C 3.6%
- D 4.8%

✓ Answer: B — 2.4% of world land | 7th largest country

7th

Largest country by area

2.4%

% of world land area

17.7%

% of world population (2011)

Feature	Detail
Latitude extent	8°4'N to 37°6'N
Longitude extent	68°7'E to 97°25'E
N-S extent	3,214 km
E-W extent	2,933 km
Northernmost point	Indira Col
Southernmost (mainland)	Kanyakumari (Cape Comorin)
Southernmost (overall)	Indira Point — submerged in 2004 Boxing Day Tsunami

Tropic of Cancer ($23\frac{1}{2}^{\circ}\text{N}$)	Passes through 8 states NE states: Tripura & Mizoram
IST = $82\frac{1}{2}^{\circ}\text{E}$	Passes through Mirzapur Clock Tower $5\frac{1}{2}$ hrs ahead of GMT

🧠 MEMORY TRICK

IST States Mnemonic: MAUCO = MP, Andhra Pradesh, UP, Chhattisgarh, Odisha

→ Continental Drift Theory

Theory / Concept	Scientist	Year
Continental Drift (Pangaea → Laurasia + Gondwana)	Alfred Wegener	1911
Convection currents in Asthenosphere (mechanism)	Arthur Holmes	—
Sea Floor Spreading	Harry Hess	1961

PANGAEA → SPLIT

All land: **Pangaea** | All water: **Panthalassa**

Split into: **Laurasia** (North) + **Gondwana Land** (South)

India was part of **Gondwana Land**

🔑 KEY FACTS

🔑 Lithosphere = Crust + Upper solid mantle → up to **200 km**

🔑 Asthenosphere → **200-400 km** (magma-filled)

🔑 **Tsunami** = Earthquake under ocean floor | Meaning: "Harbor Waves"

🔑 Hypocenter/Hypofocus = actual underground origin | Epicenter = point directly above on surface

◆ ◆ ◆

④ Polity — Inter-State Council & Sarkaria Commission 🏛️

Q4. Inter-State Council is provided under Article ____

- (A) Article 249
- (B) Article 262
- (C) **Article 263 ✓**
- (D) Article 312

✓ Answer: C — Article 263 | Inter-State Council formed 1990

SARKARIA COMMISSION (1983)

Subject: Centre-State relations

Chairman: **Ranjit Singh Sarkaria**

Members: B. Shiv Raman + S.R. Sen

B. Shiv Raman → recommended **NABARD (est. July 12, 1982)**

INTER-STATE COUNCIL

Formed: **1990** | Created by: **President**

Chairperson: **Prime Minister**

Members: All CMs + 6 Union Cabinet Ministers

Decisions: **NOT binding**

Article	Subject
Article 262	Inter-State Water Disputes Tribunal
Article 263	Inter-State Council
Article 249	Rajya Sabha can authorize Parliament to legislate on State List
Article 312	Rajya Sabha can create new All India Services



⑤ Art & Culture — Folk & Martial Dances

Q5. *Ranappa is a martial dance associated with which state?*

- ☐ A Haryana
- ☐ B Rajasthan
- ☐ C Manipur
- ☒ D Odisha ✓

✓ Answer: D — Ranappa is a martial dance of Odisha (bamboo sticks used)

Odisha Dances

Ranappa	Martial; bamboo sticks
Paika	Martial dance

Gotipua	Boys' performance
Ghumura	Tiger dance; Kalahandi
Bhag Nacha	Tiger dance
Dalkhai	Sambalpur region
Karma	Also in JH, CG, Bihar
Chhau (Mayurbhanj)	Ministry = Classical; Sangeet Natak = NOT classical

Rajasthan Dances

Kalbelia	Snake dance; UNESCO 2010
Ghoomar	Started by Bhil tribe, adopted by Rajputs
Teratali	Rajasthan (Tertali = MP)

Manipur Dances

Thang-ta	Martial; Meitei community
Lai Haraoba	Most popular dance

3 TYPES OF CHHAU

Purulia Chhau → West Bengal | Seraikela Chhau → Jharkhand | Mayurbhanj Chhau → Odisha



⑥ Agriculture — Cropping Seasons

Q6. Which of the following is NOT a cropping season in India?

- (A) Rabi
- (B) Kharif
- (C) Zaid
- (D) Barani ✓ (NOT a season — it's rain-fed farming)

✓ Answer: D — Barani = rain-fed farming technique, NOT a cropping season

Season	Sowing	Harvest	Key Crops

Kharif (Monsoon)	July–Aug	October	Paddy, Soybean, Cotton, Groundnut
Rabi (Winter)	November	April	Wheat, Mustard, Peas, Flaxseed, Rapeseed
Zaid (Short/Summer)	May–June	—	Cucumber, Melon, Watermelon, Fodder crops

BONUS FACT

Methane (Marsh Gas) is released from **paddy fields** (swampy/flooded conditions)



⑦ Chemistry — Periodic Table History

Q7. Mendeleev was unable to assign correct position to which element?

- ☐ A Helium
- ☐ B Oxygen
- ☒ C Hydrogen ✓
- ☐ D Chlorine

✓ Answer: C — Hydrogen had NO fixed position in Mendeleev's table

- ☐ **1817 Döbereiner** → **Law of Triads** (middle element = avg of 1st & 3rd by atomic mass)
- ☐ **1865 Newlands** → **Law of Octaves** (musical notes Do-Re-Mi; 56 elements; last = Thorium)
- ☐ **1869 Mendeleev** → **Periodic Table** (63 elements; 7 periods, 8 groups; left gaps for undiscovered elements)

MENDELEEV'S PREDICTIONS ✓

Eka-Aluminium → discovered as **Gallium**

Eka-Boron → discovered as **Scandium**

Eka-Silicon → discovered as **Germanium**

Drawback: **Hydrogen — no fixed position!**

ELEMENT FACTS

Hydrogen isotopes: Protium (^1H — 0 neutrons), Deuterium (^2H), Tritium (^3H — radioactive)

Oxygen: Discovered by Joseph Priestley

Chlorine: Yellowish-green gas | At. no. 17 | At. mass 35.5 (isotopes 35 & 37 in 3:1 ratio)

⑧ Polity — Types of Bills & Budget

Q8. The ___ Bill provides details of taxes proposed in the Budget

- ☒ A Finance Bill ✓
- ☐ B Private Member's Bill
- ☐ C Constitution Amendment Bill
- ☐ D Ordinary Bill

✓ Answer: A — Finance Bill (Article 117) contains tax proposals

FORMULA / FLOW

Budget Process: Presented → Discussed → Standing Committee scrutiny → Voted →
Appropriation Bill → **Finance Bill**

Budget NOT in Constitution | Article **112** → Annual Financial Statement

Bill Type	Article	Key Rule
Money Bill	Art. 110 (definition) / 109 (procedure)	Only in Lok Sabha; RS = 14 days recommending only; Speaker certifies; President CANNOT return
Finance Bill	Art. 117	All Money Bills are Finance Bills, NOT vice versa; Clause 1 = needs President's prior recommendation + Lok Sabha only
Ordinary Bill	Art. 107	Equal power both houses; deadlock → Joint Sitting (Art. 108); Speaker presides
Private Member's Bill	—	1 month prior notice; introduced by non-minister MP
Constitution Amendment Bill	Art. 368 / Part 20	Origin: South Africa ; Special majority / Special majority + State ratification

EXAM TRAP!

Joint Sitting (Art. 108): Origin = Australian Constitution | Convened only **3 times** |
Presided by **Speaker of Lok Sabha**

If Speaker absent → Deputy Speaker | If both absent → **Deputy Chairman of Rajya
Sabha** | **VP / Chairman of Rajya Sabha NEVER presides!**

→ Key Constitutional Amendments

Amendment	Year	Key Change
24th	1971	Parliament CAN amend Fundamental Rights; President MUST give assent to CAB
25th	—	Added Art. 31C; Art. 39B & C get priority over Art. 14, 19, 31
26th	—	Privy Purse abolished
42nd	—	Education → Concurrent List; many changes
44th	—	Right to Property removed from FRs → Art. 300A; "Internal disturbance" → Armed Rebellion
61st	1988 (enforced 1989)	Voting age 21 → 18
91st	—	Max CoM = 15% of Lok Sabha strength; Anti-defection applies to ministerial posts too

MEMORY TRICK

Kesavananda Bharati Case (1973): **Basic Structure Doctrine** established | Judicial review = basic feature | Not written anywhere in Constitution!



⑨ Polity — Seventh Schedule & 42nd Amendment

Q? Education was transferred to Concurrent List by which Amendment?

- ☐ A 24th Amendment
- ☒ B 42nd Amendment ✓
- ☐ C 44th Amendment
- ☐ D 61st Amendment

✓ Answer: B — 42nd Amendment moved 5 subjects from State List → Concurrent List

100

Union List subjects (earlier 97)

61

State List subjects (earlier 66)

5 SUBJECTS MOVED TO CONCURRENT LIST (42nd Amendment)

1. **Education**
2. **Forests**
3. **Weights & Measures**
4. **Protection of Wild Animals & Birds**
5. **Administration of Justice**

→ 5 Cases where Parliament can legislate on State List

Article	Condition	Validity
249	Rajya Sabha passes special majority resolution	1 year
250	National Emergency declared	During emergency + 6 months after
252	Two or more states request	Only for those states
253	International treaty enforcement	—
356	President's Rule	Until State Legislature repeals it



⑩ Economy — Types of Goods & Basic Concepts

Q10. An example of an intermediate good is?

- (A) Refrigerator sold to a household
- (B) Television sold to a household
- (C) **Copper used for making utensils ✓**
- (D) Shirt purchased by a consumer

✓ Answer: C — Copper is still in economic activity (being processed into utensils)

Type	Definition	Examples
Intermediate Good	Still in economic activity (being processed)	Copper used for making utensils
Final Good	Passed through all economic processes	Shirt bought by consumer, TV for household
Consumer Goods	Directly consumed	Food, drink

Consumer Durables	Used (not consumed)	Refrigerator, TV
Capital Goods	Used by businesses	Factory machines, laptop for teaching

OPPORTUNITY COST (Q12)

Value of the best alternative forgone

When you choose one option, you lose the next best option — that lost value = opportunity cost

MARGINAL UTILITY

Satisfaction from **one additional unit**

Law of Diminishing MU: As more units consumed → utility from each unit decreases

Cess = specific purpose; NOT shared with states

Surcharge = tax on tax; NOT shared with states



⑪ Biology — Plant Tissues

Q11. Vessels are a part of which tissue?

☒ A Xylem ✓

☐ B Phloem

☐ C Epidermis

☐ D Meristematic tissue

✓ Answer: A — Vessels are part of Xylem (Complex Permanent tissue)

→ Meristematic Tissue

- Cells continuously divide; dense cytoplasm; prominent nucleus; NO vacuole
- **Apical** → Tips of roots & shoots (increases height)
- **Intercalary** → In between (increases height)
- **Lateral** → Side of stem (increases girth/width)
- When stops dividing → **Differentiation** → becomes Permanent tissue

→ Permanent Tissue

Simple Permanent

Parenchyma	Prepares & stores food; food part = Chlorenchyma ; air-filled = Aerenchyma (lotus, aquatic plants)
Collenchyma	Provides flexibility
Sclerenchyma	Provides rigidity & toughness

Complex Permanent

Xylem	Transports water & minerals (upward) Parts: Tracheids, Vessels , Xylem fibres, Xylem parenchyma Xylem parenchyma = LIVING; all others = DEAD
Phloem	Transports food (both directions) Parts: Sieve tubes, Companion cells, Phloem parenchyma, Phloem fibres Phloem fibres = DEAD; all others = LIVING

EPIDERMIS

Outer coating of entire plant | Waxy secretion = **Cuticle** (made of **Cutin**) — most prominent in desert plants

Leaf → **Stomata** (gas exchange + Transpiration) | Guard cells regulate (turgid = open; flaccid = closed)

Guttation = Water loss at night through **Hydathodes** (leaf edges)



⑬ History — Chola Kingdom 👑

Q13. Land Revenue in the Chola Kingdom was known as?

- ☐ A Vetti
- ☐ B Land tax
- ☐ C Cess
- ☒ D Kadamai ✓

✓ Answer: D — Kadamai = Land Revenue in Chola Kingdom | Vetti = Forced labour (NOT land revenue)

CHOLA KINGDOM BASICS

Capital: **Uraiyur** | Port: **Kaveripattinam (Puhar)**

Emblem: **Tiger** 🐅

Early Cholas founder: Karaikal

Later Cholas founder: **Vijayalaya Chola** (defeated Muttaraiyar; built temple for Goddess Nisumbhasudani)

CHOLA LAND DONATIONS

Shalabhoga → Schools

Devadana → Temples

Brahmadeya → Brahmins

Pallichchandam → Jains

<i>Social Class</i>	<i>Meaning</i>
Vellalars	Rich landowners
Kadaiyyar	Landless agricultural laborers
Adimai	Slaves (most degraded class)

EXAM TRAP!

Don't confuse! Vetti = Forced labour | Kadamai = Land Revenue | Chauth = 1/4th (Maratha) | Sardeshmukhi = extra 10% (Maratha)



14 Biology — Human Brain

Q14. The part of the brain that has separate areas for hearing, smell, and sight is?

- ☒ A Cerebrum (Forebrain) ✓
- ☐ B Cerebellum
- ☐ C Medulla Oblongata
- ☐ D Hypothalamus

✓ Answer: A — Cerebrum has distinct lobes for hearing, smell, sight, reasoning

Forebrain

Cerebrum	Memory, reasoning, intelligence; hearing, smell, sight
Hypothalamus	Body temp, hunger, thirst, sleep cycle, circadian rhythm

Thalamus	Touch, feel; relay station for outer body sensations
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<i>Lobe</i>	<i>Function</i>
Frontal	Reasoning, logic
Parietal	Touch, feel
Occipital	Vision/Sight
Temporal	Hearing (ears on side)

<i>Hindbrain Part</i>	<i>Function</i>
Cerebellum	Body posture, balance = "Little Brain"
Pons	Connects cerebellum to medulla & spinal cord
Medulla Oblongata	Involuntary actions = respiration, heartbeat, vomiting

BRAIN COVERING — DAP TRICK

Meninges = 3 layers: **Dura mater** → **Arachnoid** → **Pia mater**

Middle separation = **Corpus Callosum** | Midbrain = connects forebrain & hindbrain



⑮ — ⑯ History — Medieval India

Q15. Razia Sultan was considered more capable than her brothers by?

- ☒ A **Minhaj Siraj** ✓
- ☐ B Ziauddin Barani
- ☐ C Alberuni
- ☐ D Amir Khusro

✓ Answer: A — Minhaj Siraj wrote about Razia in *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri*

RAZIA SULTAN

Period: **1236–1240** | Only female ruler in medieval Indian history

Daughter of **Iltutmish** (Slave Dynasty)

Mentioned by **Minhaj Siraj** in *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri*

<i>Book</i>	<i>Author</i>	<i>About</i>
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Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	Minhaj Siraj	Razia Sultan; medieval history
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	Ziauddin Barani	Muhammad bin Tughluq appointed low-caste to high posts
Kitab-ul-Hind	Alberuni	India (11th century)
Rihla	Ibn Battuta	Travels; came from Morocco ; written in Arabic
Shahnama	Ferdowsi	Persian epic; Mahmud of Ghazni's court
Tughlaqnama + Nuh Siphir	Amir Khusro	In Alauddin Khilji's court

Q16. *Pitara Diwara (Pietra Dura) technique was popular during the reign of?*

- ☐ A Akbar
- ☐ B Babur
- ☐ C Aurangzeb
- ☒ D Shah Jahan ✓

✓ Answer: D — Shah Jahan = Golden Period of Mughal Architecture | Pietra Dura = inlaying precious stones

→ Mughal Dynasty — Key Timeline

- ☐ **1526–30 Babur** — Original name: Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur | From Fergana | First Battle of Panipat 1526 | Used **Tulghuma formation** + **first use of gunpowder in India** | Built **Aram Bagh** (first Mughal garden, Agra)
- ☐ **1530–45 Humayun** — Defeated at Battle of Kannauj/Bilgram (1540) by Sher Shah Suri | Took refuge in **Safavid Dynasty, Iran** | Died falling from library stairs 1556 | Biography: **Humayun-Nama** by sister **Gulbadan Begum** | Built city **Dinpanah**
- ☐ **1540–45 Sher Shah Suri** — Original name: Farid Khan | Died attacking **Kalinjar Fort (1545)**
- ☐ **1556–1605 Akbar** — Crowned age 13 at Kalanaur, Punjab | Regent: Bairam Khan | 2nd Battle of Panipat 1556 (defeated Hemu) | Built **Fatehpur Sikri (1571)** in memory of Sheikh Salim Chishti | **Buland Darwaza (1575)** after Gujarat victory | Akbarnama by **Abul Fazl** (3 vols; 3rd = **Ain-i-Akbari**)
- ☐ **1628–58 Shah Jahan** — **Golden Period of Mughal Architecture** | **Pietra Dura technique**
- ☐ **1658–1707 Aurangzeb** — Built **Bibi Ka Maqbara** in memory of wife Rabia-ud-Daurani | Built by son Prince Azam Shah

AKBAR'S REFORMS

Todar Mal (Finance Minister) → **Zabt/Dahsala System** (10-year average land revenue)

Land categories: **Polaj** (most fertile) → Parauti → Chachar → **Banjar** (most barren)

Mansabdari System: Mansab = Rank | Zat (rank) + Sawar (horsemen maintained)

Charbagh style → introduced by Mughals | First proper Charbagh = **Humayun's Tomb**



17–18 History — Ancient & Medieval Miscellaneous

Q17. Which is NOT one of the traditional Kumbh Mela locations?

- ☐ A Ujjain
- ☐ B Nashik
- ☐ C Haridwar
- ☒ D Varanasi ✓ (NOT a Kumbh location)

✓ Answer: D — Varanasi is NOT a Kumbh Mela location

Ujjain

Kumbh Location ✓

Nashik

Kumbh Location ✓

Haridwar

Kumbh Location ✓

Prayagraj

Kumbh Location ✓

Q18. The inscription of Pratihara King Nagabhatta was found at?

- ☐ A Kannauj
- ☐ B Bhinmal
- ☒ C Gwalior ✓
- ☐ D Mathura

✓ Answer: C — Nagabhatta's inscription found at Gwalior

GURJAR-PRatihara DYNASTY

Founder: **Nagabhatta I** (capital: Kannauj/Bhinmal)

Real Founder: **Mihir Bhoja**

Title: **Adivaraha** (Varaha = Boar avatar of Vishnu)

Successfully resisted **Arab invasion**

TRIPARTITE STRUGGLE (~850 AD)

Three powers fighting for Kannauj:



⑪ Polity — All India Services & Article 312

Q19. Article 312 provides for the creation of new?

- ☐ A High Courts
- ☐ B Union Territories
- ☒ C All India Services ✓
- ☐ D Constitutional Bodies

✓ Answer: C — Article 312 | Rajya Sabha passes Special Majority resolution → Parliament creates new AIS

IAS

Indian Administrative Service

IPS

Indian Police Service

IFoS

Indian Forest Service (NOT Foreign!)

EXAM TRAP!

IFoS ≠ IFS! IFoS = Indian Forest Service | IFS = Indian Foreign Service (NOT an All India Service)



⑫ Geography — Layers of Atmosphere

Q20. Weather occurs in which layer of the atmosphere?

- ☐ A Stratosphere
- ☐ B Mesosphere
- ☐ C Thermosphere
- ☒ D Troposphere ✓

✓ Answer: D — Troposphere (avg. 13 km height) — weather, clouds, we live here

Layer	Key Features
Troposphere	Avg. height 13 km (poles = 8 km; equator = 18 km) Weather occurs here Lapse rate = temp ↓ 6.5°C per km or 1°C per 165 m
Stratosphere	Ozone layer here Temp increases upward Jets fly here (no weather phenomena)
Mesosphere	Meteors burn here Coldest layer Temp decreases upward
Thermosphere/Ionosphere	Ions visible Radio waves reflected Temp increases upward
Exosphere	Outermost layer

→ Greenhouse Effect & Albedo

GREENHOUSE GASES (most to least)

1. **Water Vapour** (most abundant, not regulated)
2. **CO₂** → 3. **Methane**

GHGs: transparent to insolation; opaque to terrestrial radiation

ALBEDO (REFLECTIVE POWER)

Highest: **Fresh snow**

Lowest: **Asphalt**

Old snow < Fresh snow (lower albedo)

Urban Heat Island: buildings absorb heat (low albedo), release at night

KEY FACTS

🔑 Ozone Day = **September 16** | Measured in **Dobson units**

🔑 Montreal Protocol + Vienna Convention → deal with ozone | Montreal → phase out **CFCs**

🔑 **Kigali Amendment** → phase out **HFCs**

Geography — Population Geography

Q21. Population change is affected by birth, death, and ___

- ☐ A Migration only
- ☐ B Immigration only
- ☒ C Both Immigration & Emigration ✓
- ☐ D None

✓ Answer: C — Population change = Birth rate – Death rate + (Immigration – Emigration)

Pyramid Shape	Growth Type	Examples
Triangular (upright)	Rapid growth	Kenya, Nigeria, Saudi Arabia
Bell-shaped	Slow growth	USA, Australia, Canada
Rectangular	Zero growth	Denmark, Austria
Inverted pyramid	Negative growth	Italy (ageing population)

→ Demographic Transition Model (DTM) — 4 Stages

Stage	Birth Rate	Death Rate	Population
Stage 1	High	High	Stagnant
Stage 2	High	Falls sharply	Rapid increase
Stage 3	Falls slightly	Falls further	Slowing
Stage 4	Low	Low	Stable/Zero

KEY FACTS

India's Population Explosion phase: Stage 3 → 1951 to 1981

1921 = "Year of Great Divide" + "Year of Economic Divide" → Population began growing rapidly after 1921

Reason for explosion: Better medical facilities → Death rate fell sharply

Immigration = people coming IN | Emigration = people going OUT

— Culture + Economy — Festivals & GST 🎉

Q22. In West Bengal, Durga Puja starts with which event?

- ☐ A Pahela Baisakh
- ☐ B Paush Mela
- ☐ C Gangasagar Mela
- ☒ D Mahalaya ✓

✓ Answer: D — Durga Puja starts with Mahalaya | Durga Puja = UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage

WEST BENGAL FESTIVALS

Durga Puja starts with: **Mahalaya**

Pahela Baisakh = New Year (Nababarsha)

Paush Mela = Winter fair (Shantiniketan)

Gangasagar Mela = Sagar Island

GST COUNCIL (Q23)

Article: **279A** | Members: **33**

Chairperson: **Union Finance Minister**

Centre = 1/3 vote | States = 2/3 vote

Decision needs: **3/4 majority**

Q23. GST Council decisions require which majority?

- ☐ A Simple majority
- ☐ B Two-thirds majority
- ☒ C Three-fourths majority ✓
- ☐ D Unanimous decision

✓ Answer: C — 3/4 majority required in GST Council | Constitutional body under Art. 279A



History — Simon Commission & Freedom Struggle 🙌

Q24. *Simon Commission was boycotted because it had no?*

- ☐ A Women members
- ☒ B Indian members ✓
- ☐ C Legal experts
- ☐ D Provincial representatives

✓ Answer: B — Simon Commission had 7 members, ALL British → "Simon Go Back!"

- ☐ 1927 Simon Commission formed | Came to India: 1928 | 7 members, all British | Slogan: "Simon Go Back" (coined by Joseph Merelli) | Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab Kesari) died during protests
- ☐ 1928 HSRA (Hindustan Socialist Republican Association) founded by Chandrashekhar Azad at Feroz Shah Kotla | Members: Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru | Killed Saunders (intended: Scott) to avenge Lala Lajpat Rai → Lahore Conspiracy Case
- ☐ 1929 Bhagat Singh + Batukeshwar Dutt threw bomb in Central Legislative Assembly (then surrendered) | Aided escape: Durgavati Devi (Durga Bhabhi) wife of Bhagwati Charan Vohra (wrote "Philosophy of the Bomb")
- ☐ Mar 23, 1931 Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru hanged

HRA vs HSRA

HRA (1924) — Founded in Kanpur by Sachin Sanyal

Members: Sachin Sanyal, Roshan Singh, Ram Prasad Bismil

Kakori Train Incident → 1925

HSRA (1928) — Founded by Chandrashekhar Azad at Feroz Shah Kotla

Azad died at: Alfred Park (now CS Azad Park), Prayagraj

NEHRU REPORT + JINNAH 14 POINTS

Birkenhead challenged → "Form it yourself"

Congress formed committee under Motilal Nehru → Nehru Report

Muslim League → Delhi Proposals

Jinnah submitted 14 Points (response to Nehru Report)

🔑 KEY FACTS

🔑 **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919)**: Introduced Dyarchy in provinces | Bicameral legislature at centre | Extended separate electorates | Stipulated commission after 10 years (Simon came after only 8 years)



Quick Revision Flash Table — All 24 Questions

Q.No	Question	Answer
Q1	Lohit tributary of?	Brahmaputra
Q2	Licensing NOT removed for?	Alcohol, Cigarettes, Explosives
Q3	India's % of world area?	2.4% 7th largest
Q4	Inter-State Council = Article?	Article 263 Formed 1990 Chairman = PM
Q5	Ranappa dance = which state?	Odisha (martial, bamboo sticks)
Q6	NOT a cropping season?	Barani (rain-fed farming, not a season)
Q7	Mendeleviev couldn't place?	Hydrogen
Q8	Budget taxes = which Bill?	Finance Bill (Art. 117)
Q9	Education → Concurrent List = which Amendment?	42nd Amendment (5 subjects moved)
Q10	Example of intermediate good?	Copper used for making utensils
Q11	Vessels are part of?	Xylem Xylem parenchyma = only LIVING part
Q12	Opportunity cost = ?	Value of best alternative forgone
Q13	Land revenue in Chola = ?	Kadama (Vetti = forced labour)
Q14	Brain area for hearing, smell, sight?	Cerebrum Occipital = sight Temporal = hearing
Q15	Who called Razia more capable?	Minhaj Siraj (Tabaqat-i-Nasiri)
Q16	Pietra Dura technique?	Shah Jahan (Golden Period of Mughal Architecture)
Q17	NOT a Kumbh Mela location?	Varanasi (4 = Ujjain, Nashik, Haridwar, Prayagraj)
Q18	Nagabhatta inscription found at?	Gwalior Real founder = Mihir Bhoja (Adivaraha)
Q19	Article 312 = creation of?	All India Services (IAS, IPS, IFoS)
Q20	Weather occurs in which layer?	Troposphere (avg. 13 km; lapse rate = 6.5°C/km)
Q21	Population change factors?	Birth + Death + Migration (Immigration + Emigration)
Q22	Durga Puja starts with?	Mahalaya UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage
Q23	GST Council majority?	3/4 majority Art. 279A Finance Minister =

		Chair
Q24	Simon Commission boycotted?	No Indian members HSRA founded 1928 Kakori 1925



END OF BLADE SESSION 2 NOTES

All 24 Questions Covered  | Revise the Quick Table every day before exam! 